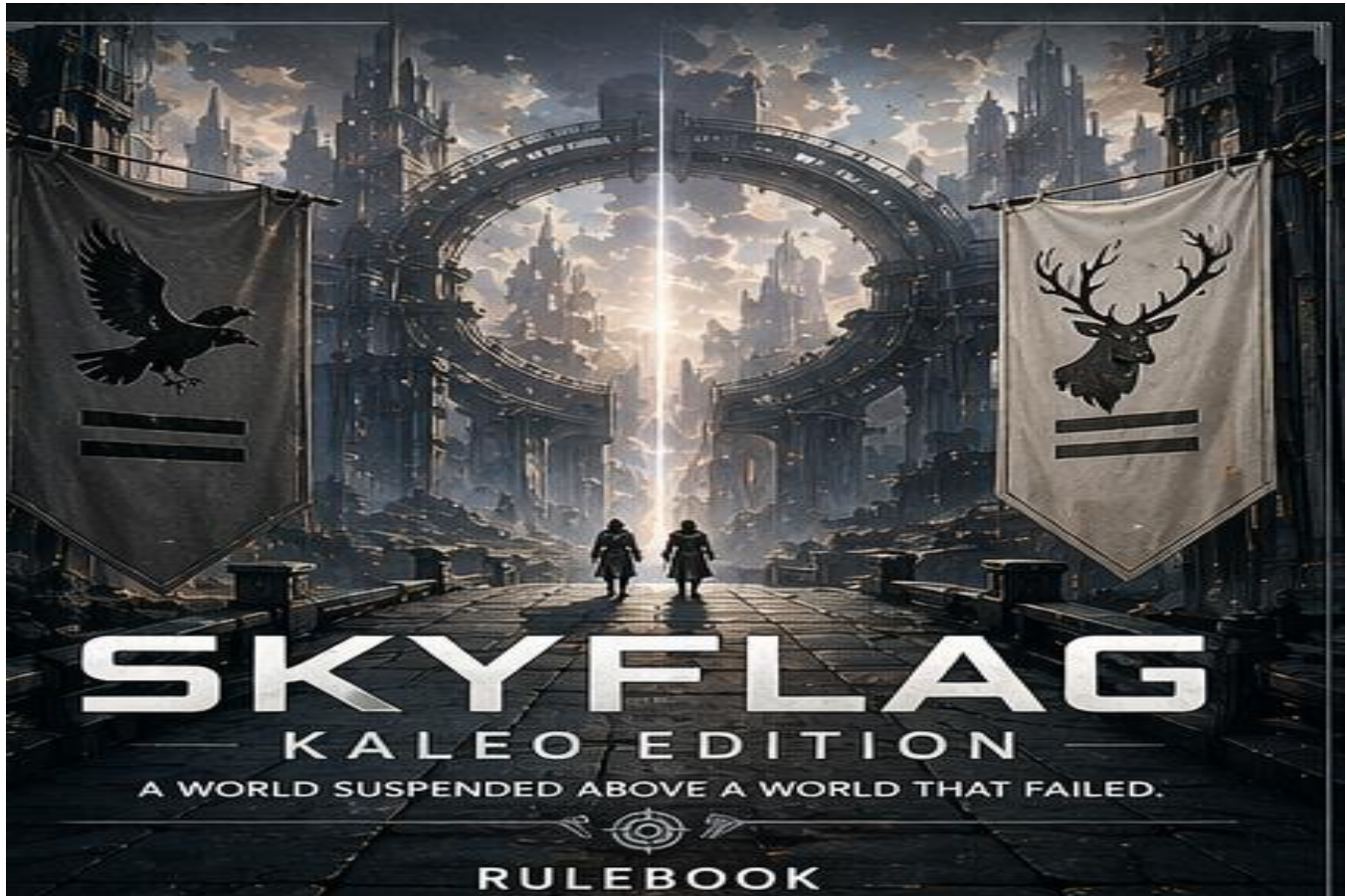


# SKYFLAG

K A L E O E D I T I O N



*A world suspended above a world that failed.*

R U L E B O O K · E D I T I O N 1 . 0

C R O S S - B O A R D R U L E

2 players · ages 8+ · 45–75 minutes

playskyflag.com · © 2026 Limnology Research Corp.  
Dr. Nelson Jatel, P.Ag.

# Kaleo

## *A world above a world that failed*

Long ago, when the planet below gave way to salt, dust, and ruined basins, the Aetheri lifted what remained of civilization into a three-layer arcology. The lowest layer — the **Terran** — holds the reservoirs, farms, workshops, and crowded human districts. Above it, the **Meridian** carries charged air, transit architecture, and the old routing systems. At the summit rests the **Empyrean** — the quiet upper shell where the Aetheri left their highest instruments.

At the centre of the Empyrean, and only there, waits the **Caelum Nexus**. The lower layers have no such central shrine. What they have, instead, are corners.

Each clan placed three dormant claim-seals in the corners of its own territory on each layer — proofs of presence left for the Aetheri to witness. *Defend your seals; the opponent's seals are your targets.* Only by crossing into the opposing clan's territory and neutralizing all three of its seals may a Captain earn the right to approach the Nexus. The Aetheri did not trust survival to strength alone; they built Kaleo as a system of proofs, and the proof demanded is reach.

*“The Aetheri did not build three layers. They built three answers to the same question.”*





## The Two Clans

For seven generations, Kaleo was one people. The schism came during a crisis whose name the archives still record — a disease that tore through the lower districts while the council debated what to do. One faction argued for immediate escalation: open the Aetheri archives, petition the Nexus. The other argued for containment: preserve what remained, refuse panic, work with the tools already at hand.

The containment faction won the argument by one vote. Their victory stabilized Kaleo at the cost of two hundred thousand Terran residents who might have been saved. The escalation faction did not forget. Over four generations they consolidated into the **Grey Ravens**. The faction that had won became the **White Stags**. Each clan drew its name and totem from the temperament that had defined its position in that ancient debate.

Six generations later, both clans still claim duty. Both claim restraint. Both claim they are acting for Kaleo. Both are correct. Neither is complete. The contest that decides Kaleo's next age is the raid on the opposing clan's three seals, and the answer of the Nexus.



### G R E Y R A V E N S

*"We have been here longer than the crisis. We will be here longer than its answer."*



### W H I T E S T A G S

*"We were given a path. If we do not walk it, it becomes a monument to our refusal."*

# Contents

This rulebook proceeds in the order you will need it. Read pages 1–4 before your first game. Page 5 is a single-page reference you can keep beside the board during play.

|                                 |    |
|---------------------------------|----|
| 1 · Overview .....              | 5  |
| 2 · Components & Setup .....    | 6  |
| 3 · The Four Pieces .....       | 9  |
| 4 · Turn Sequence .....         | 14 |
| 5 · The Lifts .....             | 16 |
| 6 · The Flags & the Nexus ..... | 17 |
| 7 · Win Conditions .....        | 18 |
| 8 · Game Phases .....           | 19 |
| 9 · Quick Reference .....       | 20 |





# 1 • Overview

SkyFlag is a two-player tactical race played across a three-layer arcology. Each player commands four pieces — a Captain, a Soldier, a Rover, and a Pilot — and pursues the opposing clan's three claim-flags, one on each layer of the board. Flags may be captured in any order. Once all three of the opponent's flags are claimed, your Captain must land on the **Caelum Nexus** at Space(3,3) to win.

Pieces move and capture by geometry alone. There are no special abilities, no cards, no dice. Everything the game offers comes from the interaction of four movement profiles with the architecture of three stacked boards and the four vertical transit points — the **Lifts** — that connect them.

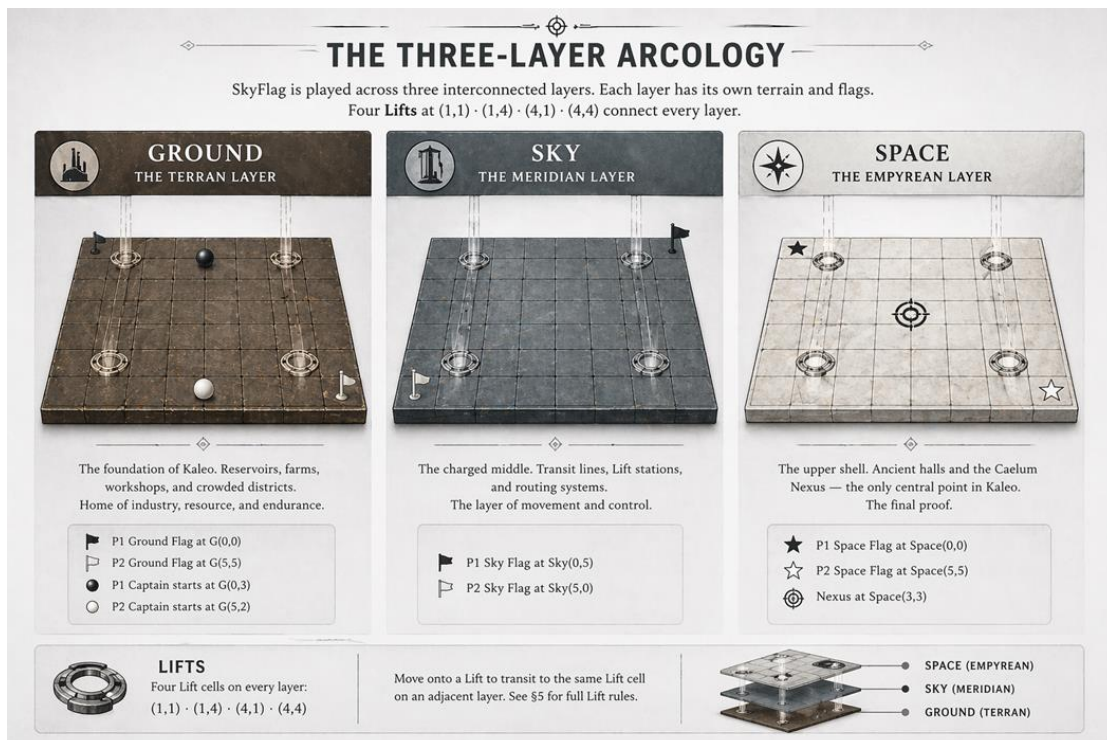
## THE OBJECTIVE

Each player must capture the opponent's three flags, one on each layer of the arcology. Capture all three — in any order — then land your Captain on the Nexus at Space(3,3) to win.

## Board coordinates

All three layers share the same coordinate system. A cell is identified as **Layer(row, col)**. **Row 0** is the top edge; **row 5** is the bottom. **Col 0** is the left edge; **col 5** is the right. The three layers are:

- **Ground** — the Terran layer
- **Sky** — the Meridian layer
- **Space** — the Empyrean layer, containing the Nexus at Space(3,3)



## 2 · Components & Setup

### Components

| Item              | Quantity & notes                                                      |
|-------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Three-layer board | Ground, Sky, and Space — each a 6×6 grid sharing coordinates.         |
| Player pieces     | 4 per player: Captain, Soldier, Rover, Pilot. P1 = slate; P2 = ivory. |
| Flag markers      | 3 per player: Ground Flag (🚩), Sky Flag (🚩), Space Flag (★).          |
| Lift tokens       | 12 total — four per layer, marking the Lift cells.                    |
| Nexus marker      | 1 — placed at Space(3,3).                                             |

### The Board

The board comprises three stacked 6×6 layers. Four **Lifts** at (1,1) · (1,4) · (4,1) · (4,4) connect every layer. Flag positions are fixed and symmetric for the two players. Each layer diagram below shows initial setup.

#### GROUND · THE TERRAN LAYER

|    | c0   | c1 | c2   | c3   | c4 | c5   |
|----|------|----|------|------|----|------|
| r0 | 🚩 P1 |    |      | ● P1 |    |      |
| r1 |      | ↑  |      |      | ↑  |      |
| r2 |      |    |      |      |    |      |
| r3 |      |    |      |      |    |      |
| r4 |      | ↑  |      |      | ↑  |      |
| r5 |      |    | ● P2 |      |    | 🚩 P2 |

Ground board. P1 Ground Flag (🚩) at G(0,0), top-left. P2 Ground Flag at G(5,5), bottom-right. Captain starts (●): P1 at G(0,3); P2 at G(5,2). Lifts (↑) at (1,1), (1,4), (4,1), (4,4).

## SKY · THE MERIDIAN LAYER

|    | c0   | c1 | c2 | c3 | c4 | c5   |
|----|------|----|----|----|----|------|
| r0 |      |    |    |    |    | 🚩 P1 |
| r1 |      | ↑  |    |    | ↑  |      |
| r2 |      |    |    |    |    |      |
| r3 |      |    |    |    |    |      |
| r4 |      | ↑  |    |    | ↑  |      |
| r5 | 🚩 P2 |    |    |    |    |      |

Sky board. P1 Sky Flag at Sky(0,5), top-right. P2 Sky Flag at Sky(5,0), bottom-left.

## SPACE · THE EMPYREAN LAYER

|    | c0   | c1 | c2 | c3   | c4 | c5   |
|----|------|----|----|------|----|------|
| r0 | ★ P1 |    |    |      |    |      |
| r1 |      | ↑  |    |      | ↑  |      |
| r2 |      |    |    |      |    |      |
| r3 |      |    |    | ☉ NX |    |      |
| r4 |      | ↑  |    |      | ↑  |      |
| r5 |      |    |    |      |    | ★ P2 |

Space board. P1 Space Flag (★) at Space(0,0); P2 Space Flag at Space(5,5) — each echoes the Ground Flag corner (the Aetheri Echo Point). The Nexus (☉) sits at Space(3,3).

## LIFTS — ALL LAYERS

The four Lift positions are the same on all three layers: (1,1) · (1,4) · (4,1) · (4,4). No two Lifts are within king-move of each other. A Captain cannot threaten two Lifts from a single position — Lift defence is by positioning, not cluster control.

## Setup

|                      | P1 · Slate   | P2 · Ivory   | Notes                                    |
|----------------------|--------------|--------------|------------------------------------------|
| <b>Captain start</b> | Ground (0,3) | Ground (5,2) | In hand; deploy costs 1 activation.      |
| <b>Soldier</b>       | In hand      | In hand      | Deploy during play — 1 activation.       |
| <b>Rover</b>         | In hand      | In hand      | Deploy during play — 1 activation.       |
| <b>Pilot</b>         | In hand      | In hand      | Deploy during play — 1 activation.       |
| <b>Ground Flag</b> 🚩 | G(0,0)       | G(5,5)       | Place at each player's corner.           |
| <b>Sky Flag</b> 🚩    | Sky(0,5)     | Sky(5,0)     | Opposite corner on the Sky layer.        |
| <b>Space Flag</b> ★  | Space(0,0)   | Space(5,5)   | Echoes the Ground Flag corner.           |
| <b>Nexus</b> ☉       | Space(3,3)   | Space(3,3)   | Shared finish cell.                      |
| <b>Activations</b>   | 2 per turn   | 2 per turn   | Both players start with the same budget. |

### SETUP STEPS

1. Place 12 Lift tokens — 4 per layer at (1,1), (1,4), (4,1), (4,4).
2. Place P1's flags at G(0,0), Sky(0,5), Space(0,0). Place P2's flags at G(5,5), Sky(5,0), Space(5,5).
3. Place the Nexus marker ☉ at Space(3,3).
4. All pieces (Captain, Soldier, Rover, Pilot) start in hand. Determine the first player by any mutual method.
5. Each turn, both players have 2 activations.



# 3 · The Four Pieces

All tactical power comes from movement, capture geometry, and positioning. Pieces use the same movement on every layer. The summary table below is followed by a detailed card for each piece, with a movement diagram.

| Piece          | Movement                                                     | Capture                                                           | Role                                                                |
|----------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Captain</b> | King-move: 1 sq in any of 8 directions.                      | Lands on opponent's cell.                                         | The winning piece. Must capture all 3 flags and land on Space(3,3). |
| <b>Soldier</b> | Forward only. First move $\leq 2$ sq; subsequent moves 1 sq. | 1 sq diagonally forward.                                          | Deploys from hand. Promotes to Captain at the far row on Ground.    |
| <b>Rover</b>   | Orthogonal $\leq 2$ sq.                                      | 1 step only — cannot capture at 2 squares.                        | Lift-corridor guard. Blocks approaches.                             |
| <b>Pilot</b>   | Diagonal $\leq 2$ sq. May jump over an intervening piece.    | Lands on opponent beyond the jump — the jumped piece is captured. | Flanks Lift approaches. Reaches threats over defending pieces.      |

## 3. THE FOUR PIECES

Each player commands four pieces. They move and capture by geometry, not by cards or dice.



**CAPTAIN**  
The Commander

Leads the claim. Moves with full freedom in any direction.

**MOVEMENT**  
Up to 1 cell in any of the 8 surrounding directions.

**CAPTURE**  
Capture by landing on a cell occupied by an enemy piece.

**ROVER**  
The Pathfinder

Controls routes and corridors. Moves orthogonally with precision.

**MOVEMENT**  
Up to 1 or 2 cells orthogonally (straight lines only).

**CAPTURE**  
Capture only on the 1-cell move (not on the 2-cell move).

**PILOT**  
The Skirmisher

Strikes along diagonals with speed and precision.

**MOVEMENT**  
Up to 1 or 2 cells diagonally.

**CAPTURE**  
May jump over exactly one enemy piece (on the 2-cell move) and land beyond it to capture.

**SOLDIER**  
The Vanguard

Advances the line. Moves forward with discipline.

**MOVEMENT**  
Moves forward only.

**CAPTURE**  
Capture 1 cell diagonally forward.

**PROMOTION**  
When a Soldier reaches the far edge of the Ground layer (row 5 for P1, row 0 for P2), it is promoted to a Captain. It immediately gains Captain movement and capture rules.

**ALL PIECES**  
No special abilities.  
No cards. No dice.  
Geometry decides everything.

# CAPTAIN · Dantec

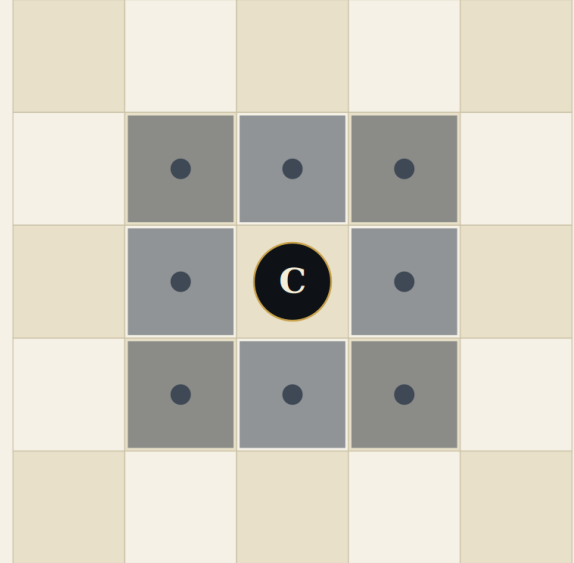
Slate — Renn Dantec · Ivory — Sera Dantec

The only piece — along with a promoted Soldier — that can capture flags and answer the Nexus. Every other piece exists to protect her approach.

|                 |                                                               |
|-----------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Movement</b> | 1 square in any of 8 directions (king-move). All layers.      |
| <b>Capture</b>  | By landing on the opponent's cell.                            |
| <b>Role</b>     | Win-capable. Captures flags. Finishes the game at Space(3,3). |

## CAPTAIN · king-move

1 square in any of 8 directions. Captures by landing on opponent.



# SOLDIER · Durren

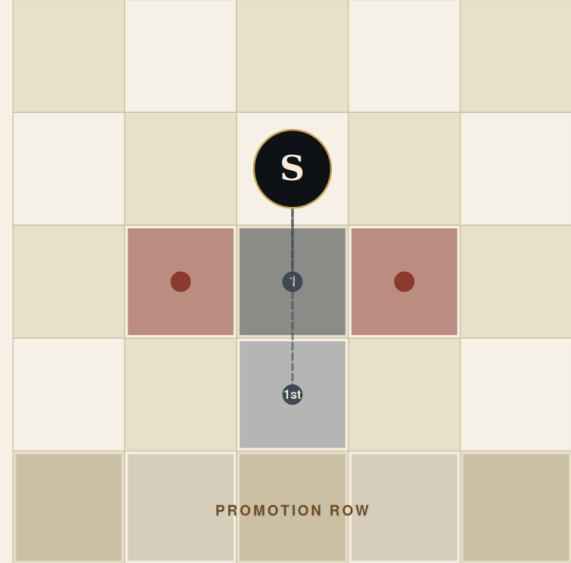
Slate — Toren Durren · Ivory — Kael Durren

*Deploys from hand. Forward-only. A Soldier that reaches the back rank on Ground changes the game: a second win-capable piece appears on the board.*

|                 |                                                                                                             |
|-----------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Movement</b> | Forward only (P1 = down rows; P2 = up rows). First move $\leq 2$ sq; subsequent 1 sq. Cannot move backward. |
| <b>Capture</b>  | 1 square diagonally forward only.                                                                           |
| <b>Role</b>     | Controls approach corridors. Promotes to Captain at the far row.                                            |

## SOLDIER · forward-only

1 sq forward;  $\leq 2$  sq on first move. Captures diagonally forward. Reaches far row → Captain.



Forward move

Diagonal-forward capture

## SOLDIER PROMOTION

When a Soldier reaches the far row on the Ground layer (row 5 for P1; row 0 for P2), it promotes immediately to a Captain. A promoted Captain has full Captain powers: it may capture flags and land on Space(3,3) to finish the game.

Flag-capture progress is shared across both Captains — you do not need to capture all three flags with the same Captain. Players may therefore field up to two Captains simultaneously.



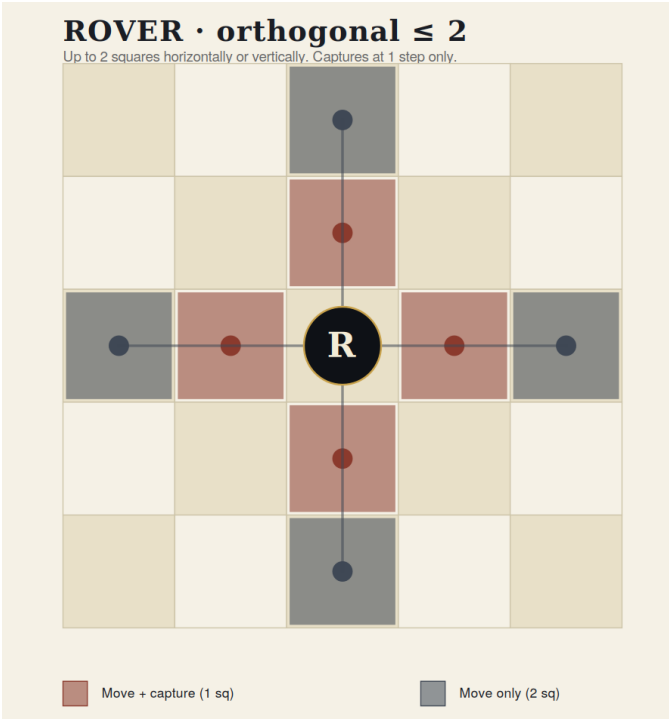


# ROVER · Thandiwe

Slate — Mox Thandiwe · Ivory — Iva Thandiwe

Rovers lock down Lift corridors and force the opponent to reroute. A Rover does not need to strike — a Rover only needs to stand in the correct place.

|          |                                                                       |
|----------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Movement | Orthogonal $\leq 2$ squares (horizontally or vertically). All layers. |
| Capture  | 1 step only — cannot capture at 2 squares.                            |
| Role     | Limited rook. Corridor control. Lift defence.                         |



# PILOT · Voss

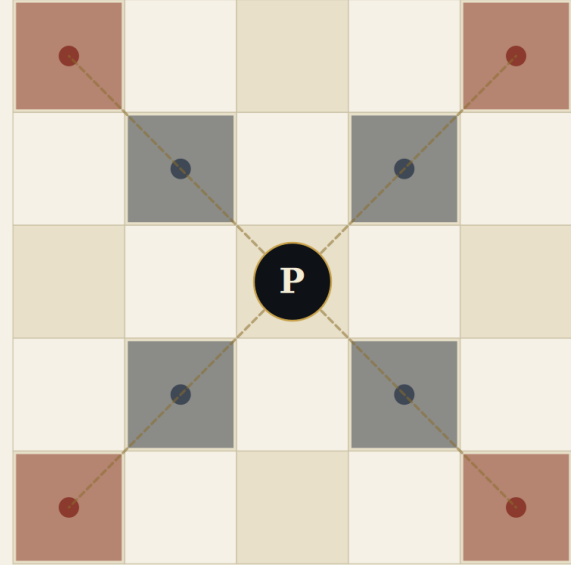
Slate — Zara Voss · Ivory — Arin Voss

*The Pilot converts a screen into a liability. The one piece that reaches a threat over defending pieces — arriving one square sooner than the defender expected.*

|                 |                                                                   |
|-----------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Movement</b> | Diagonal $\leq 2$ squares. May jump over an intervening piece.    |
| <b>Capture</b>  | Lands on opponent beyond the jump — the jumped piece is captured. |
| <b>Role</b>     | Limited bishop with jump-capture. Flanks Lift approaches.         |

## PILOT · diagonal $\leq 2$ with jump

Up to 2 squares diagonally. May jump over a piece to capture beyond.



1-sq diagonal 2-sq diagonal / jump-capture



## 4 • Turn Sequence

Each turn proceeds through the following steps in order. You must take every action available within your activation budget — you cannot pass if a legal action exists.

| Step                         | What you do                                                                                                                                                     |
|------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>1 • Deploy (optional)</b> | Place 1 piece from hand onto your starting cell on the Ground layer. Costs 1 activation. A newly deployed piece cannot move on the same activation.             |
| <b>2 • Activate</b>          | Take up to 2 actions with deployed pieces. Each action is one of: move a piece, capture, step up or down a Lift. You must act if any legal action is available. |
| <b>3 • Flag check</b>        | If one of your Captains (original or promoted) just landed on a cell containing an opponent's flag, capture it immediately. Remove the flag marker.             |
| <b>4 • Nexus check</b>       | If all three of your opponent's flags have been captured and one of your Captains just landed on Space(3,3), you win immediately.                               |
| <b>5 • Pass initiative</b>   | The other player now takes their turn.                                                                                                                          |

### ACTIVATION SUMMARY

Standard: 2 activations per turn for both players.

Lift use: move to a Lift cell (1 activation on one turn), then step up or down one layer (1 activation on the next turn). The Lift step itself cannot capture.

Flag capture is automatic at step 3 — it does not consume an activation, and it grants no bonus activation.



# THE TURN SEQUENCE

- 1 START OF TURN**  
  
 Begin your turn.  
 Confirm game phase  
 and board state.
- 2 MOVE**  
  
 Move one of your pieces  
 using its movement  
 profile.
- 3 CAPTURE (IF ABLE)**  
  
 If you land on an enemy flag  
 with your Captain, capture it.  
 Remove the flag from play.
- 4 LIFT (IF CHOSEN)**  
  
 If on a Lift, you may move  
 between layers.  
 One layer per turn.
- 5 END OF TURN**  
  
 Your turn ends.  
 Pass to your opponent.  
 The battle continues.

**YOUR GOAL**



Capture all three enemy  
 flags, one on each layer.  
 Then land your Captain  
 on the Nexus at Space(3,3)  
 to win.

**REMEMBER**



- Plan your move.
- Control key spaces.
- Protect your Captain.
- Reach, Capture, Ascend.
- Claim the Nexus.



## 5 · The Lifts

Lifts connect the three layers. They always occupy the same (row, col) on each layer: (1,1) · (1,4) · (4,1) · (4,4). These four positions form a square ring inside the board, each exactly one king-move from a flag corner on the Ground layer.

### USING A LIFT — TWO TURNS

Using a Lift takes two separate activations on two separate turns:

- Turn A: move your piece onto the Lift cell on its current layer (1 activation).
- Turn B: step your piece up or down one layer via that Lift (1 activation).

A piece cannot arrive at a Lift and step through it in the same activation. Exception: if a piece ends a turn already on a Lift cell, it may step up or down on its very next activation.

### LIFT OCCUPATION RULE

A piece on a Lift cell on one layer blocks the Lift step from the adjacent layer. The blocking piece does NOT need to be on the same Lift cell as the ascending piece — it needs to be at the same (row, col) on the layer above or below.

The blocked Lift step cannot capture the blocking piece. To clear a blocked Lift, remove the blocking piece through normal play on its own layer.

Strategy: parking a defender on the Space Lift above your own flag (P1: Space(1,1); P2: Space(4,4)) simultaneously guards the approach AND blocks that Lift from Sky, denying the opponent an ascent.

Lift independence: no two Lifts are within king-move of each other. A piece on one Lift cell cannot threaten any other Lift. There is no *cluster fortress* — each Lift must be defended individually through positioning.



## 6 · The Flags & the Nexus

Each player captures the opponent's three flags, placed in the opponent's corners. Landing on your own flag cell does nothing — your flag stays in place until the opponent captures it. Flags may be captured in any order — Ground, Sky, and Space are fully independent objectives. Once all three of the opponent's flags are captured, your Captain must reach the Nexus at Space(3,3) to win.

|                      | P1 · Slate                          | P2 · Ivory                          |
|----------------------|-------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| <b>Ground Flag</b> 🚩 | G(5,5) — bottom-right               | G(0,0) — top-left                   |
| <b>Sky Flag</b> 🚩    | Sky(5,0) — bottom-left              | Sky(0,5) — top-right                |
| <b>Space Flag</b> ★  | Space(5,5) — bottom-right           | Space(0,0) — top-left               |
| <b>Nearest Lift</b>  | (4,4) for G & Space · (4,1) for Sky | (1,1) for G & Space · (1,4) for Sky |
| <b>Nexus</b> ☉       | Space(3,3) — shared finish cell     | Space(3,3) — shared finish cell     |

### FLAG CAPTURE

A Captain (original or promoted) lands on an opponent's flag cell → the flag is captured instantly. Remove the marker. A friendly or enemy piece on the flag cell does NOT block capture — a Captain may always land on and capture an opponent's flag regardless of who else occupies it. Flag capture does not grant a bonus activation. The turn continues with its normal budget. After all three opponent flags are captured, your Captain must reach Space(3,3) to win.

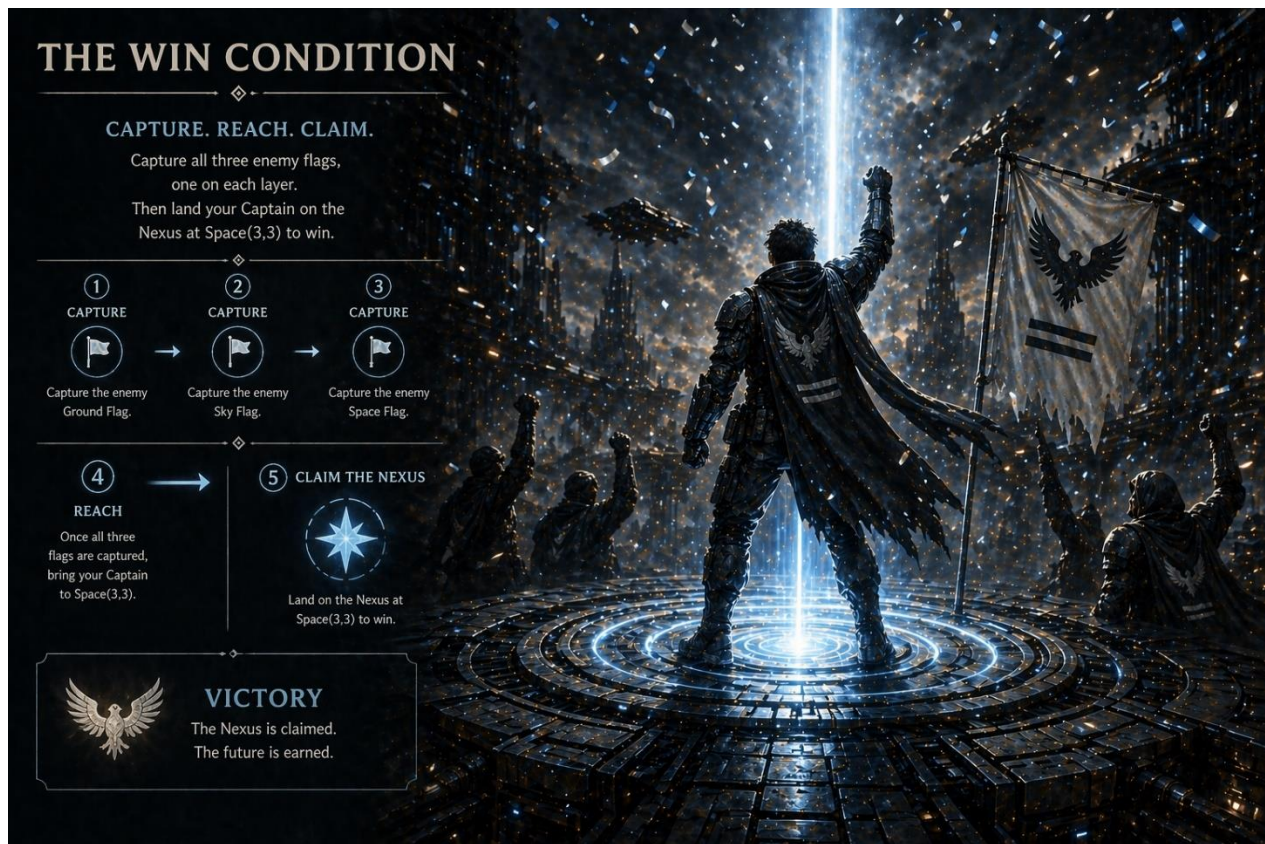
## The Aetheri Echo Point

Each player's Ground and Space flags share the same (row, col) — the **Aetheri Echo Point**. Continuity of position across layers was the proof the Aetheri required. The Sky flag sits at the diagonally opposite corner, enforcing a genuine horizontal traverse on the central layer.



## 7 · Win Conditions

| Condition                     | How it triggers                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|-------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Win by Nexus (primary)</b> | A Captain on your side captures all three of your opponent's flags — Ground, Sky, and Space, in any order — and then lands on the Nexus cell at Space(3,3). Either the original Captain or a promoted Captain may trigger this win. Flags may be captured across both Captains collectively. |
| <b>Win by Elimination</b>     | Your opponent has no Captain on the board and none in hand, and no Soldier remaining that could promote to a Captain. All Captain-capable pieces have been permanently captured.                                                                                                             |
| <b>Turn-limit Draw</b>        | 180 turns without a win. Tiebreak, in order: (1) flags captured; (2) pieces remaining; (3) opponent pieces captured; (4) highest layer occupied; (5) Captain Chebyshev distance to Space(3,3).                                                                                               |



### Competitive Note

Skyflag contains a minor structural asymmetry in its spatial geometry. Specifically, space (3,3) is not equidistant from the Player 1 (P1) and Player 2 (P2) starting positions when evaluated through optimal captain movement paths. Under efficient play, P1 can reach this key space in 18 actions, whereas P2 requires 19. This one-action differential introduces a slight first-player advantage, analogous to the initiative observed for White in Chess. To mitigate this imbalance in competitive play, matches are structured as a best-of-three series, with players alternating starting positions between games. This format ensures that each player has equal exposure to both positional advantages over the course of the match.

# 8 · Game Phases

The three-flag system with a Nexus finish creates four natural phases of play. Flags may be pursued in any order, but the geometry rewards a sequential path.

| Phase            | Layer  | What happens                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
|------------------|--------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 · Ground Race  | Ground | Both Captains on Ground racing across the board to capture the opposing Ground Flag. Soldiers deploy during play. Rovers and Pilots may ascend to Sky or Space immediately. Early Lift skirmishes determine approach control. ~3–4 rounds.            |
| 2 · Sky Crossing | Sky    | Sky transit is the hardest leg: the target Sky Flag is diagonally opposite from the Lift nearest your Ground approach (four king-moves). Both Captains must cross the full board width in Sky. Most contested phase. ~4–5 rounds.                     |
| 3 · Space Flag   | Space  | After Sky, the Captain ascends to Space. With echoed corners, the target Space Flag sits at the same position as the target Ground Flag — immediate recognition, but the opponent may already be contesting the layer. ~2–3 rounds under competition. |
| 4 · Nexus Finish | Space  | With all three flags captured, the Captain must converge on Space(3,3). The Nexus is central — 2 or 3 king-moves from any Space Flag — and either Captain (original or promoted) can finish. 2–3 activations minimum.                                 |

## THE GAME PHASES

A BATTLE OF REACH. A TEST OF PURPOSE.

**1 OPENING**  
Establish and advance.  
Pieces begin in their starting positions. Take the initiative and move into position.

Establish control. Plan your route. Watch your opponent.

**2 MIDGAME**  
Clash and capture.  
Engage the enemy, capture their flags, and fight for the advantage.

Capture one flag on each layer. Any order.

**3 ASCENT**  
Use the Lifts.  
Move through the Lifts to shift layers and shorten the distance to your goal.

Four Lifts connect all three layers. Move. Shift. Adapt.

**4 APPROACH**  
Seize the moment.  
With all three flags captured, push your Captain toward the Nexus at Space(3,3).

All three flags captured? Now the final reach begins.

**5 RESOLUTION**  
Claim the Nexus.  
Land your Captain on the Nexus at Space(3,3) to win the game.

Land on the Nexus. Victory is earned. The future is yours.

**REMEMBER**

**CAPTURE**  
Enemy flags give you the right to approach the Nexus.

**LIFTS**  
Move between layers. One layer per turn.

**PROTECT**  
Guard your Captain. Losing your Captain ends your turn.

**REACH**  
The Nexus is only on Space layer at (3,3). That is where it ends.

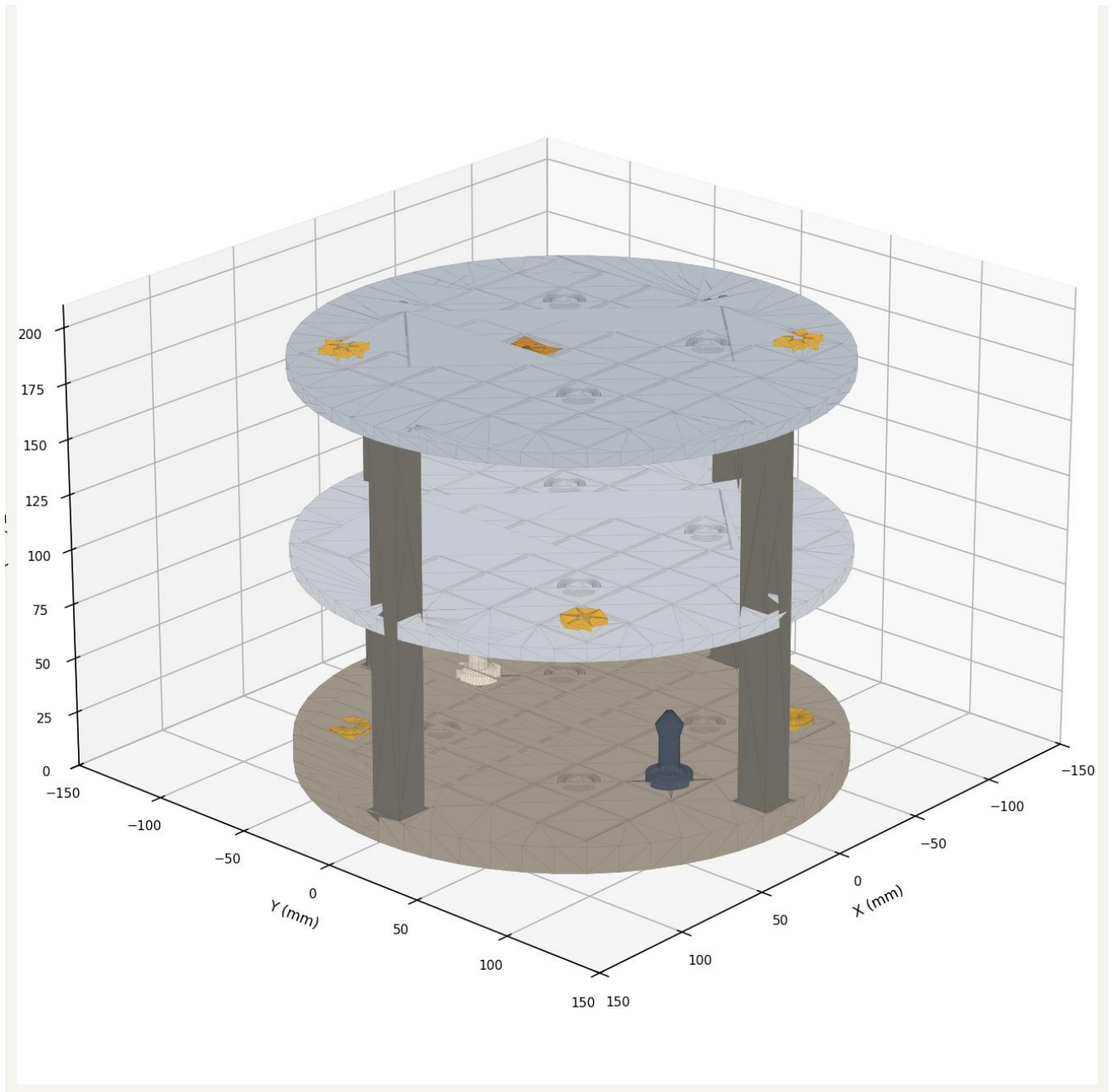
## 9 · Quick Reference

Keep this page beside the board during play.

| Rule                   | Summary                                                                                                        |
|------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Win</b>             | Captain captures all 3 opponent flags (Ground, Sky, Space) in any order, then lands on Space(3,3).             |
| <b>P1 targets</b>      | G(5,5) · Sky(5,0) · Space(5,5)                                                                                 |
| <b>P2 targets</b>      | G(0,0) · Sky(0,5) · Space(0,0)                                                                                 |
| <b>Nexus ☉</b>         | Space(3,3) — shared finish cell.                                                                               |
| <b>Lifts</b>           | (1,1) · (1,4) · (4,1) · (4,4). Same on all layers. Two-turn transit. Not within king-move of each other.       |
| <b>Lift occupation</b> | Piece above or below blocks the Lift step from the adjacent layer. The step cannot capture.                    |
| <b>Activations</b>     | 2 per turn. Flag capture does not grant a bonus.                                                               |
| <b>Captain</b>         | King-move (1 sq, 8 dirs, all layers). Capture by landing. Flag-capable. Wins on Space(3,3).                    |
| <b>Rover</b>           | Orthogonal $\leq 2$ sq. Capture at 1 step only.                                                                |
| <b>Pilot</b>           | Diagonal $\leq 2$ sq. May jump an intervening piece to capture beyond.                                         |
| <b>Soldier</b>         | Forward-only. First move $\leq 2$ sq. Capture: diagonal-forward. Promotes to Captain at the far row on Ground. |
| <b>Promotion</b>       | Soldier reaching far row on Ground becomes a Captain. Can capture flags and trigger the Nexus win.             |
| <b>Any layer</b>       | Any piece may ascend or descend via Lift at any time.                                                          |
| <b>Turn limit</b>      | 180 turns. Tiebreak: flags > pieces > captures > layer > distance to Space(3,3).                               |



# Board Game Visual Reference Sheet



Game Box Graphic (depiction)

